



Each spot is a colony of thousands of bacteria that grew from a single bacterium in the dirty handprint.



SURGERY

If disease or injury damages an organ inside the body, doctors may need to perform surgery to repair the damage. Patients are first given drugs called anesthetics to make them fall asleep and to prevent pain. The surgeon then makes precise cuts in the skin in order to open up the body and gain access to the damaged area. Surgeons work in spotlessly clean operating theaters to prevent germs from entering the patient's body during an operation.

WOW!

Given warmth and sufficient food, a single bacterium can divide and give rise to 5 billion trillion offspring in just one day.

FIGHTING CANCER

Sometimes body cells stop working properly and begin to multiply out of control like germs, forming lumps known as tumors. This deadly disease is called cancer. Cancer is difficult to treat because drugs that attack cancer cells also harm healthy body cells. To help destroy tumors, doctors fire beams of powerful radiation at them—a treatment called radiotherapy.

► **RADIOTHERAPY** *This patient is being treated for skin cancer. A beam of radiation is pointed at a tumor from several different angles, killing the cancer cells without harming the healthy tissue around it.*

